

Body beautiful

The crusaders took back to Europe new customs that they

learned in the Middle East. Cosmetics such as rouge to redden the cheeks and henna to color hair became common for women. Glass mirrors replaced polished metal discs. Perfumes to scent clothes and the body were used. Being clean became popular!

Roman numerals

I II III IV V VI VII VIII IX

Arabic numerals

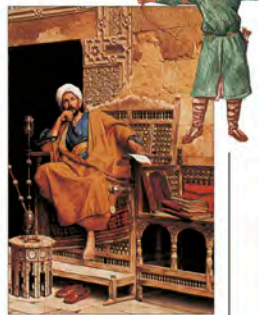
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

One, two, three . . .

The Muslims used a series of numbers, called Arabic numerals, which were much easier to use than those of the old Roman system. They are used today throughout the world.

Bookworms

Arab learning was more advanced than that of the crusaders. They had lots of books and libraries at a time when there were very few in Europe. The crusaders took many books back with them.



Healing arts

Muslim doctors were very good surgeons and were skilled in using plants and herbs to make medicines. They used opium and myrrh to ease pain when people were having operations.



Musical instruments

The Muslims invented a musical instrument called the oud, which was called the lute in Europe. The modern guitar was developed from this instrument.



Great inventors

The Muslims made fine scientific instruments like this astrolabe. It used the positions of the stars and planets to show travelers which way to go in the empty deserts.



A Muslim foot soldier usually carried a round shield for protection. It may have been made of wood or of layers of hardened leather sewn together.

Boots made of leather or felt were the most common footwear for a Muslim soldier.

